

LaunchDarkly Well-Architected

A framework for engineering organizations that build, ship, and govern systems with LaunchDarkly.

LDWA is the answer to "are we using this right?" — an opinionated set of principles, focus areas, best practices, and review questions that describe what a healthy LaunchDarkly-managed system looks like. It is cloud-agnostic, applies whether you run on AWS, GCP, Azure, on-prem, hybrid, or edge, and spans the full LaunchDarkly portfolio: flags, contexts, Guarded Releases, Release Pipelines, AI Configs, Observability, Guardian, and Federal.

THE SEVEN PILLARS

01**Safe Release & Progressive Delivery**

Reversible, measurable, progressive exposure for every change.

02**Operational Excellence**

Treat the LD layer like the production system it is.

03**Security & Compliance**

Govern access and change. Guardian + Federal at home here.

04**Reliability & Resilience**

Graceful degradation when SDK, network, or LD itself is impaired.

05**Governance & Artifact Lifecycle**

Every artifact has an owner and a retirement plan.

06**Experimentation & Measurement**

Hypotheses, metrics, holdouts, captured decisions.

07**Performance & Cost Efficiency**

Latency budgets, event volume, MAU/MCI, AI cost guardrails.

+**Lenses**

Regulated Industries, AI/GenAI, DX, Mobile, Hybrid, Edge, SaaS, Migration, Growth.

TEN GENERAL DESIGN PRINCIPLES

01 Default to safe**02** Decouple deploy from release**03** Make rollouts reversible**04** Target small, expand deliberately**05** Measure what you ship**06** Treat LD artifacts as code**07** Build for graceful degradation**08** Govern access and change**09** Operate the LD layer like production**10** Make the system simpler over time

WHO IT'S FOR

Platform engineers, SREs, release managers, product engineers, EMs and architects, CTOs, solutions architects, and partners — across any LaunchDarkly customer or prospect, regardless of cloud or runtime.

HOW TO USE IT

Read the framework intro, then pick a pillar that maps to your current pain. Or run a structured workload review using the workbook to surface risks and produce a prioritized improvement plan. Re-review quarterly.